SECURITY

SIEM & SOC Operations Visual Guide

Collect everything, correlate smartly — the security operations center playbook.

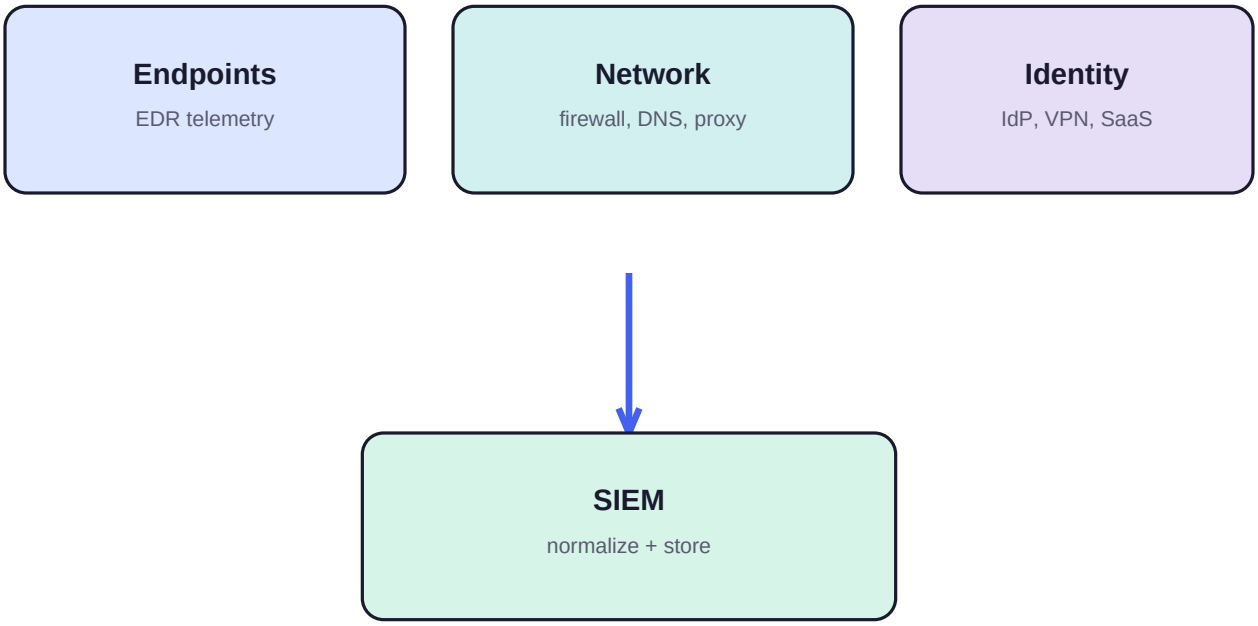
ANIMATED WALKTHROUGH

Step through pages to play the animation

STEP 1/6

Log Sources Feed the SIEM

Visibility first — you can't detect what you don't collect.



Normalize to a common schema with synced clocks — correlation is impossible when timestamps and field names disagree.

STEP 2/6

Correlation Rules

Single events are noise; patterns are signal.

5 failed logins + 1 success + new country = 'possible account takeover'

rule example

- Write rules from known attacker behavior (MITRE ATT&CK is the menu).
- Tune thresholds per environment — the same rule fires differently in dev vs prod.
- Version-control rules like code; peer-review changes.

STEP 3/6

Alert Triage Tiers

Not every alert deserves a human at 3 AM.

Tier 1

triage: true/false positive, enrich

Tier 2

investigate: scope, contain

Tier 3

hunt + engineer: fix detection gaps

Escalation criteria in writing — Tier 1 must know exactly what goes up and what closes. Ambiguity here burns analysts out.

STEP 4/6

Playbooks & SOAR

Repeatable response, automated where safe.

- Playbook per alert type: first 15 minutes scripted (isolate, snapshot, notify).
- Automate enrichment (threat intel, asset context) — never automate destructive containment without approval.
- SOAR orchestrates: SIEM alert → enrich → ticket → isolate → notify, in minutes.
- Drill playbooks quarterly; a playbook nobody has run is fiction.

STEP 5/6

Metrics That Matter

Measure the SOC like an engineering team.

MTTD
mean time to detect

MTTR
mean time to respond

Precision
true-positive rate

If MTTD is months and precision is 5%, you don't have a detection program — you have a log warehouse. Fix the rules, not the analysts.

STEP 6/6

The Tuning Lifecycle

Detection is never 'done'.

- Review top-noisiest rules weekly — tune or disable chronic false positives.
- After every incident: did we detect it? If not, write the missing rule.
- Threat intel feeds new rules; purple-team exercises validate them.
- Retire rules for decommissioned systems — stale rules are pure noise.

STEP ✓/✓

Key Takeaways

SIEM & SOC — Remember

- Collect broadly (endpoint, network, identity) and normalize with synced clocks.
- Correlation rules turn event noise into attack patterns — source them from ATT&CK.
- Tier triage with written escalation criteria; protect Tier 1 from ambiguity.
- Playbooks script the first 15 minutes; automate enrichment before containment.
- Track MTTD, MTTR, and precision — tune rules, don't blame analysts.
- Detection is a lifecycle: tune weekly, write rules from incidents, retire the stale.

Keep exploring

Pair this guide with the matching video walkthroughs
and hands-on labs at interstitiumlabs.dev